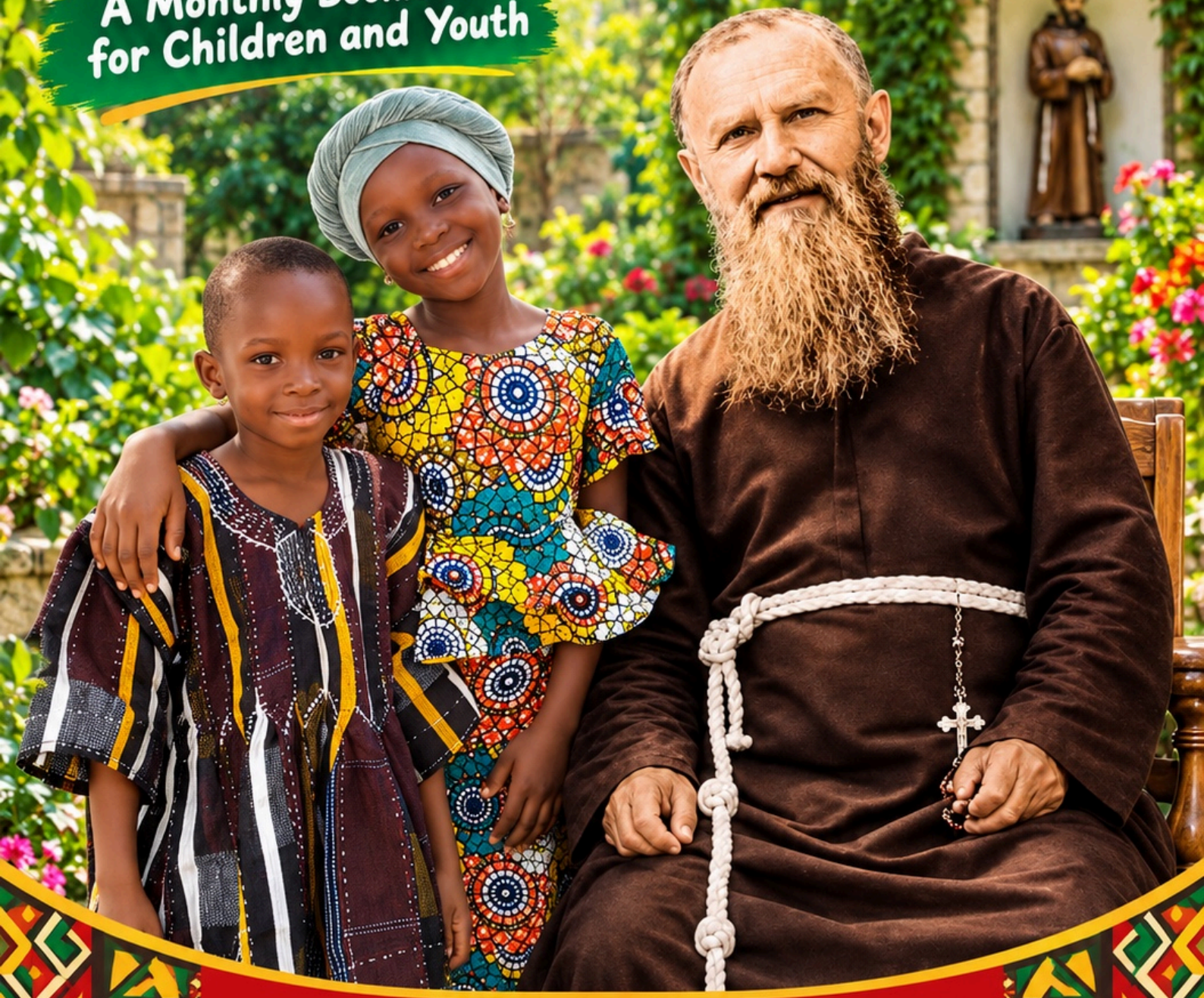
Pioneer Kids

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A Monthly Booklet for Children and Youth



Franciscan Missionary Brothers (CMSF)

PIONEER KIDS

EDITORIAL

Little Hearts, Great Dreams

Growing in Faith, Knowledge, Courage and Compassion

Dear Young Friends,

Every great journey begins with a small step, and every beautiful life begins with a heart willing to learn, love, and serve.

With great joy, I welcome you to another edition of Pioneer Kids, a magazine dedicated to inspiring children and young people through meaningful stories, faith, knowledge, and human values.

In this edition, we journey through different countries, cultures, and centuries, discovering beautiful lessons for everyday life.

The story of St. Jerome and the Lion teaches us compassion and kindness. Sohphoh Mission reminds us how education, dedication, and loving service can transform an entire community. The inspiring life of Bro. Paulus Moritz shows us that true greatness lies in serving others.

Through Mackafui and Deco, we discover the courage to tell the truth. The Japanese art of Kintsugi teaches us that failures and painful experiences need not destroy our hopes. With patience and love, we can begin again.

In The Lost Sheep, Jesus reminds us that every person is precious in God’s eyes. The Seven Wonders of the World awaken our curiosity about history, culture, and human creativity. Finally, The Day Kojo Asked a Question invites us to discover the beauty of a life dedicated to God and humanity.

Dear children, remember that you do not need to be rich, powerful, or famous to make a difference. A kind word, a helping hand, an honest action, or a loving smile can brighten someone’s life.

As you read these pages, may you grow not only in knowledge but also in wisdom, compassion, courage, and faith.

The world does not merely need intelligent people; it needs good human beings with loving hearts.

May Pioneer Kids continue to plant little seeds of goodness that will one day blossom into beautiful lives.

“Small hands can do great things when guided by loving hearts.”

With affection, prayers, and best wishes,
Bro. Joby P. Baby CMSF
Editor — Pioneer Kids

PIONEER KIDS

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Saint Jerome and the Lion

A Traditional Tale of Kindness, Friendship and Trust

Long ago, there lived a holy and learned man named Jerome. He loved God's Word and devoted many years to translating and revising the Scriptures in Latin. His work helped shape the Bible known as the Vulgate.

But alongside the accounts of his learning, people passed down a remarkable story about his friendship with a lion.

Our story begins at a monastery in Bethlehem, near the wilderness.



One evening, as the sunlight faded and the garden grew quiet, Jerome sat absorbed in prayer. Suddenly, a low growl broke the silence.

He looked up—and froze.

Only a few steps away stood a great lion!

Its thick mane framed its face, and its powerful body filled the narrow garden path. For a moment, Jerome's heart beat faster.

Then he noticed something.

The lion was holding one paw above the ground. Its eyes seemed weary, and its growl sounded more like a cry of pain.

Jerome's fear softened into compassion.

"Come closer, poor creature," he whispered. "Let me see what troubles you."

The lion slowly lowered itself before him.

A sharp thorn had pierced its paw. The wound had become swollen and painful, and every step hurt. Somehow, the suffering animal had found its way to Jerome.

When the saint led it into the monastery, the other monks scattered.

"A lion!" someone cried.

Doors slammed. Sandals hurried down the passage. Soon, Jerome and his unusual visitor stood alone.



Jerome brought the lion into his room. With patient hands, he removed the thorn, washed the wound and gently dressed it with oil and a bandage.

The lion lay still, trusting him.

"There," Jerome said softly. "You will feel better now."

That evening, a friendship began.

As the days passed, the lion's paw healed. Yet it showed no wish to return to the wilderness. Wherever Jerome went, the lion followed.

The monks gradually discovered that their frightening visitor was a gentle companion. It never harmed the monastery's animals. Instead, it watched over them and kept other wild creatures away.

Among those animals was a hardworking donkey.

Every day, the donkey pulled a cart into the wilderness to bring back firewood. Before long, the lion began walking beside it. The two became familiar companions: the little donkey with its patient steps, and the great lion with its watchful eyes.



While a monk gathered wood, the donkey grazed nearby and the lion kept guard.

But one afternoon, the warmth and stillness made the lion sleepy. It stretched out on the ground, closed its eyes and drifted into a deep sleep.

At that moment, a caravan of merchants came along the path.

Seeing the donkey grazing alone, they caught it and led it away.



When the lion awoke, its friend was gone.

It searched among the rocks, along the tracks and beyond the bushes. It listened for the sound of hooves.

Nothing.

At last, tired and troubled, it returned to the monastery alone.





"Where is the donkey?" the monks demanded.

The lion could only stand before them.

Someone whispered, "Perhaps it has eaten the donkey."

Soon, the whisper became an accusation.

"We should never have trusted a wild animal!"

Sadly, Jerome believed them. He looked at the lion with disappointment.

From that day, the lion was no longer allowed to sleep in his room. It would also have to do the missing donkey's work.

Each morning, the great animal was harnessed to the cart and sent to bring back firewood.

The lion had done nothing wrong. Yet it could not explain what had happened.

It could not say, “I searched for my friend.”

It could not say, “Please believe me.”

So it pulled the heavy cart in silence.



The work was tiring, but something else hurt far more: Jerome, its dearest friend, no longer trusted it.

Still, the lion remained at the monastery. Day after day, it did the work asked of it.

Then, one morning, everything changed.

As the lion travelled through the wilderness with the cart, it spotted a caravan approaching.

Camels moved slowly along the dusty path. Merchants walked beside them.

And there, among the animals, was a familiar pair of long ears.

The donkey!



In an instant, the lion recognised its friend.

With a mighty roar, it rushed towards the caravan.

The merchants fled in terror, leaving their animals behind. But the lion had no wish to hurt them. It had found what it had been searching for.

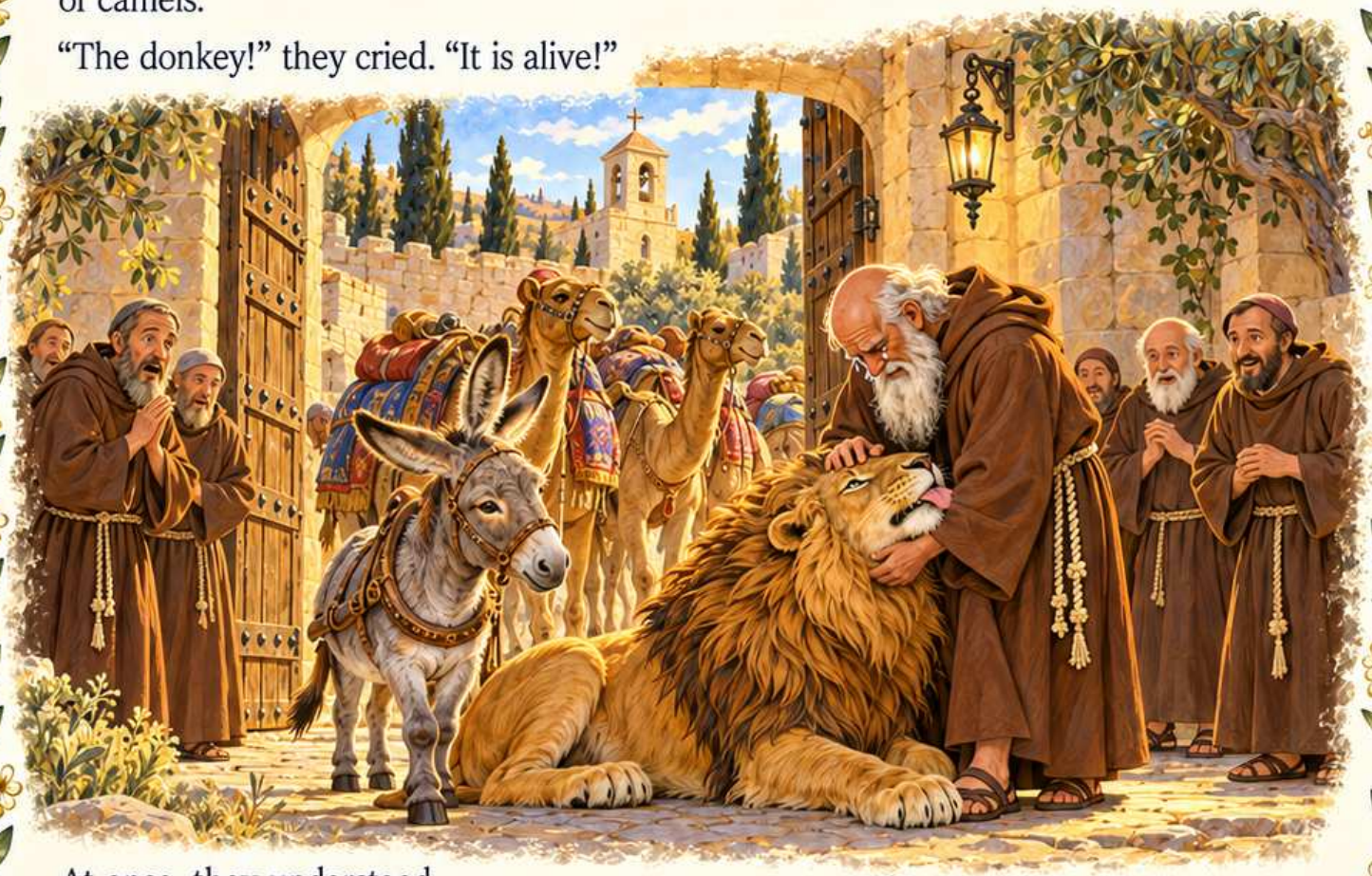
Gathering the donkey and the abandoned camels, it drove them towards the monastery.



Imagine the monks' astonishment!

Through the gate came the lion, followed by its missing friend and a long procession of camels.

"The donkey!" they cried. "It is alive!"



At once, they understood.

The lion had never harmed its companion. They had blamed an innocent creature without knowing the truth.

Jerome hurried forward.

He saw the donkey. He saw the camels. Then he looked into the lion's eyes.

His own eyes filled with tears.

"My faithful friend," he whispered. "We were wrong about you."

The lion settled at his feet and gently licked them, as though it had been waiting all those months for this welcome.

Soon, the merchants arrived, searching for their camels.

They stopped in amazement. The lion that had frightened them in the wilderness was resting peacefully beside Jerome!

The merchants admitted that they had taken the donkey and asked forgiveness. They offered valuable gifts to make amends.

Jerome refused their rich presents. Instead, they promised to provide oil each year for the lamps in the monastery church.



Then they departed with their camels, leaving the donkey safely at home.

Peace returned to the monastery.

The monks had learned a lesson they would never forget, and the friendship between Jerome and the lion grew stronger than ever.



Once again, the lion stayed close to the saint. It rested near him as he worked, followed him as he walked and kept him company through the quiet hours.

Years passed.

Jerome grew old. His steps became slower, and illness weakened him. The lion watched over its friend, remaining beside him as faithfully as before.



At last, the day came when Jerome died.

The lion stood near him in silence.

It looked into the face of the man who had once bent down to heal its wounded paw—the friend who had given it a home.

For a few moments, it did not move.

Then a sorrowful cry rose from its chest.



Slowly, the lion turned, walked through the monastery gate and disappeared into the wilderness.

The monks never saw it again.

But the story of that unusual friendship lived on: a story of a wounded paw, a helping hand, a painful misunderstanding and a friendship restored.

A Lesson to Carry in Your Heart

Be gentle towards those who suffer. Listen before you judge. When you discover that you were wrong, have the courage to ask forgiveness.

Even the strongest creature can have a wounded heart—and a little kindness can begin a beautiful friendship.

WHEN HOPE FOUND A HOME

The Story of Sohphoh Mission







In the green hills of **Meghalaya**, there was a village called **Sohphoh**. Clouds floated over the hills, and the countryside was beautiful. But life in the village was difficult.

There was no proper road, electricity, reliable water supply or nearby medical care. The people also lacked a proper church where they could gather to pray.

Many children had no opportunity to go to school. While children elsewhere carried schoolbags, these children spent their days looking after cows and buffaloes.

Yet every child had precious gifts: the ability to learn, to create and to dream. They needed an opportunity for those gifts to grow.

EVERY CHILD CARRIES A DREAM

A small village can hold great dreams. With love, learning and encouragement, those dreams can grow.

You can be a light! Share a book, help a friend with a lesson, or speak a kind word. Your kindness may give someone the courage to try again.

Dear Jesus, help us see the gifts in every child and give each other a chance to shine. Amen.

God Led the Brothers to Sohphoh





Then God led the **Franciscan Missionary Brothers** to Sohphoh. Following the example of St. Francis of Assisi, they came with faith and a desire to serve.

They listened to the families and saw the children who were growing up without an education. There was much to do. Where could they begin?

They began with the people, especially the children. Little by little, opportunities for learning opened. Simple classrooms became places of discovery.

Children who had spent their days tending animals began to discover letters, numbers and books. A pencil could feel unfamiliar in a small hand. A word might need to be read many times.

The Brothers and teachers encouraged them to keep trying. A letter became a word. A word became a sentence. Soon, a child could open a book and understand its pages. **What a wonderful discovery!**

KEEP TRYING, LITTLE LEARNER!
Every new word is a step forward. You do not have to learn everything today. Be brave, ask questions and try again tomorrow.

New Lessons, New Confidence





The fields were still part of the children's lives, but now their world was growing wider. They could learn about places beyond their village, ask new questions and imagine different possibilities for their future.

The mission grew through patient work, prayer and cooperation with the community. Every lesson taught and every child encouraged helped build something that had once seemed far away.

In just six years, Sohphoh became a centre of learning.

The children developed knowledge, skills and confidence. They began to enjoy educational opportunities that had previously seemed available only to children in towns and cities.

Their gifts had always been there. Now they had a chance to shine. The children worked hard, their families supported them, and the Brothers and teachers walked beside them.

GREAT DREAMS CAN BEGIN IN SMALL PLACES
Your home may be far from a city, but your dreams can travel far. Learn with joy and use your gifts to help others.

A Place to Gather and Pray









In the early days, the people had no proper church where they could gather to pray. These photographs show places of prayer that have become part of the mission today.

The cross reminds us of Jesus and his love for every person. In prayer, we thank God, bring him our worries and ask for strength to care for one another.

The Franciscan spirit calls us to see each person as a brother or sister. A school lesson, a kind welcome and a helping hand can all become ways of sharing God's love.

Faith becomes visible when love becomes action.

LET LOVE BECOME ACTION

Pray with a grateful heart. Then share that love through a kind word, a helping hand or a welcome for someone who feels alone.

Schoolbags and Growing Dreams







Look at the children in their school uniforms! Education has opened new doors in Sohphoh. With books, lessons and encouragement, children are discovering their talents.

Their families, village and culture remain part of who they are. What they learn today can help them serve their community tomorrow.

Every child deserves a chance to learn, grow and dream.

SHARE A LITTLE HOPE
Help a friend with a lesson. Share a book. Your kindness can help another child believe: I can learn too!

A Future Full of Hope





Sohphoh's journey reminds us that **every child deserves an opportunity to learn**. The children always had gifts. Education gave those gifts room to grow.

God worked through the Franciscan Missionary Brothers, teachers, families and the efforts of the children themselves. Patient service helped a village become a centre of learning and hope.

Following St. Francis of Assisi means caring for one another as brothers and sisters. We can share God's love through the ordinary things we do each day.

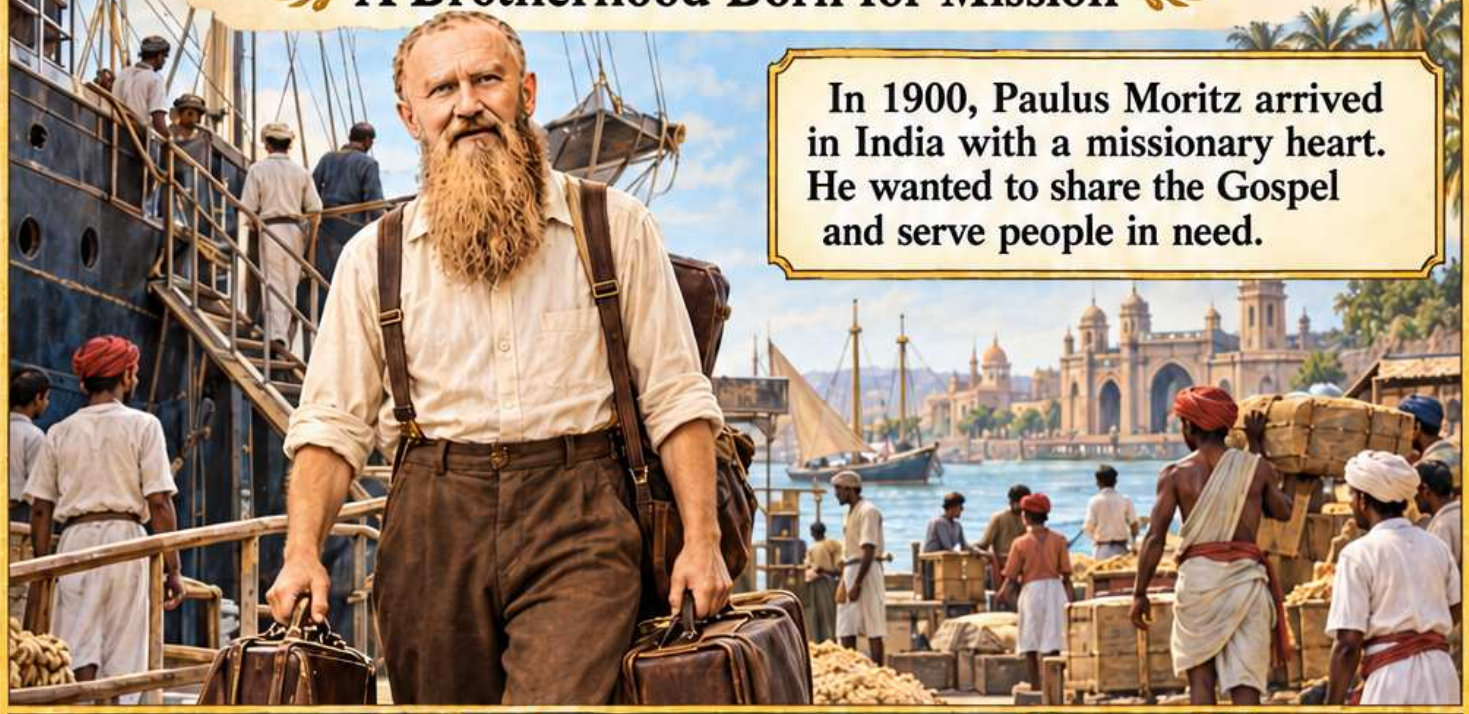
You can help a new story begin! Share a book, help a classmate with a lesson, welcome a shy child or thank your teacher. Even a small kindness can give someone courage.

A Thought for Pioneer Kids
Great dreams can grow in small villages. Let us help every child discover: my life has value, my gifts matter, and I have something good to share.

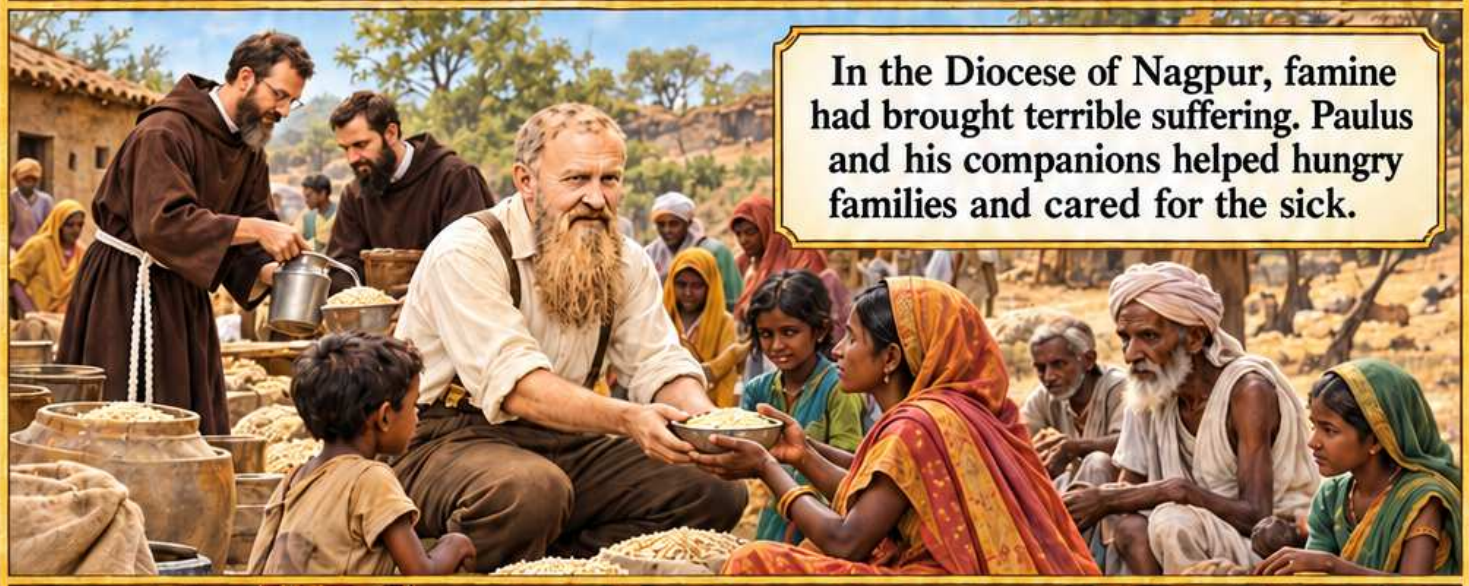
A Little Prayer
Dear Jesus, bless the children of Sohphoh and all children who long to learn. Bless the Brothers, teachers and families who care for them. Help us to study with joy, encourage one another and share our gifts with love. Amen.

Brother Paulus Moritz

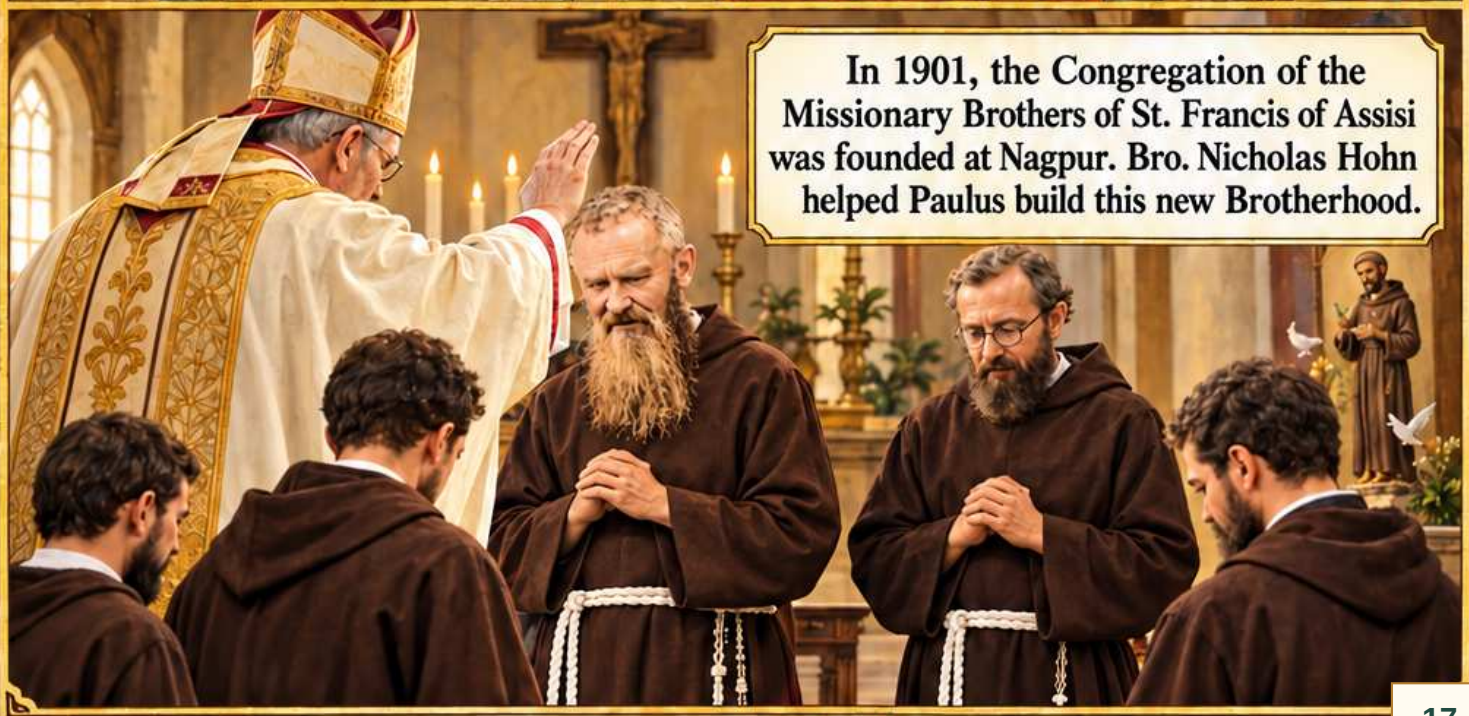
A Brotherhood Born for Mission



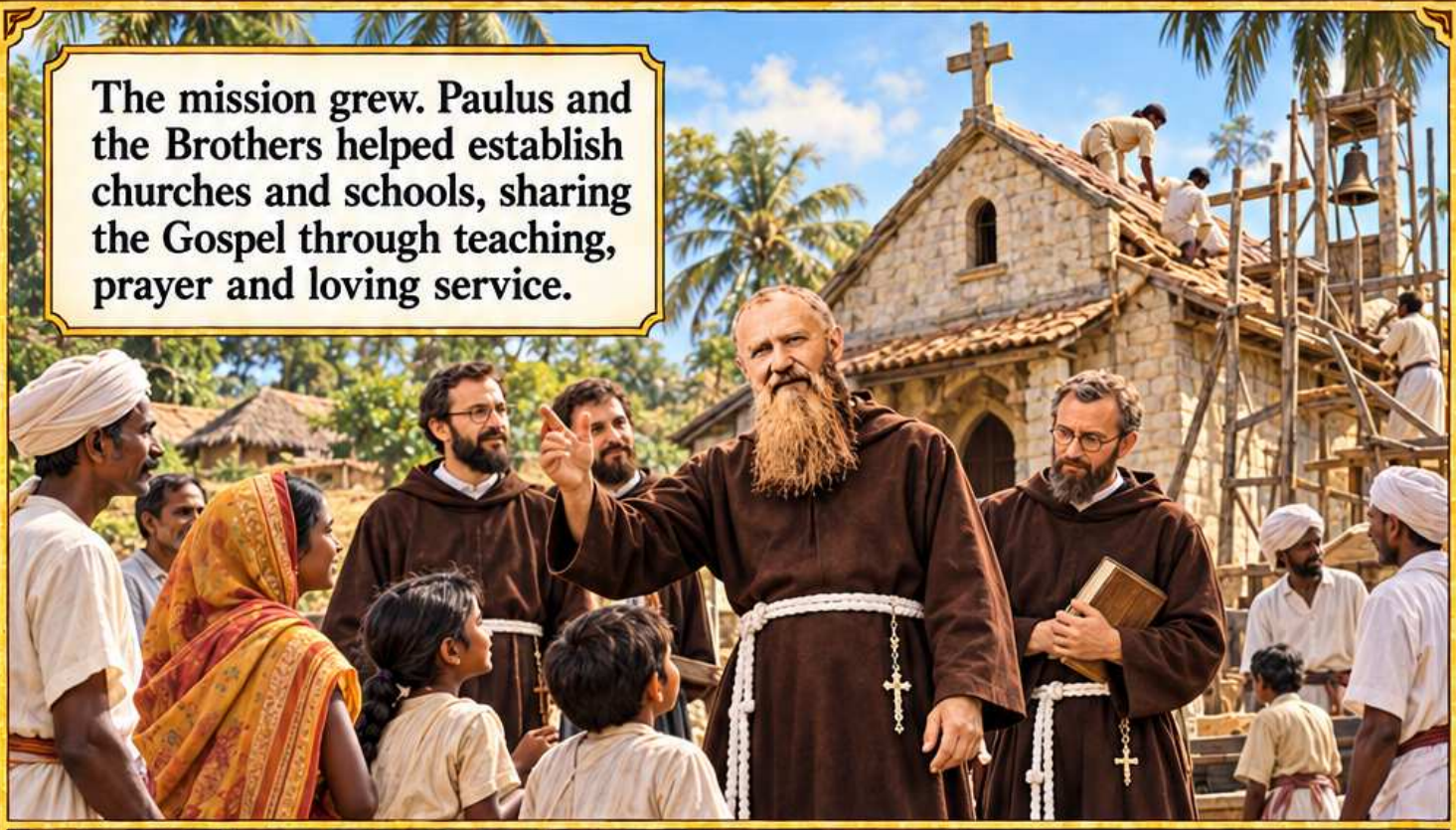
In 1900, Paulus Moritz arrived in India with a missionary heart. He wanted to share the Gospel and serve people in need.

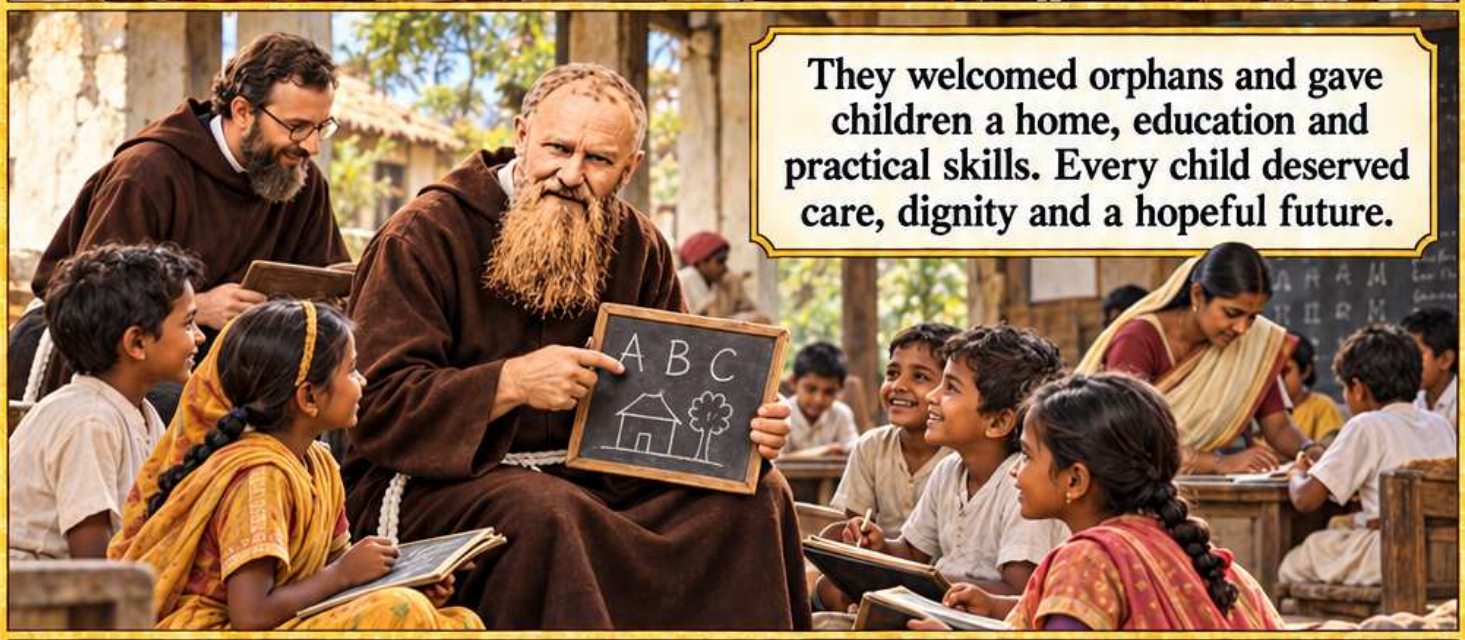


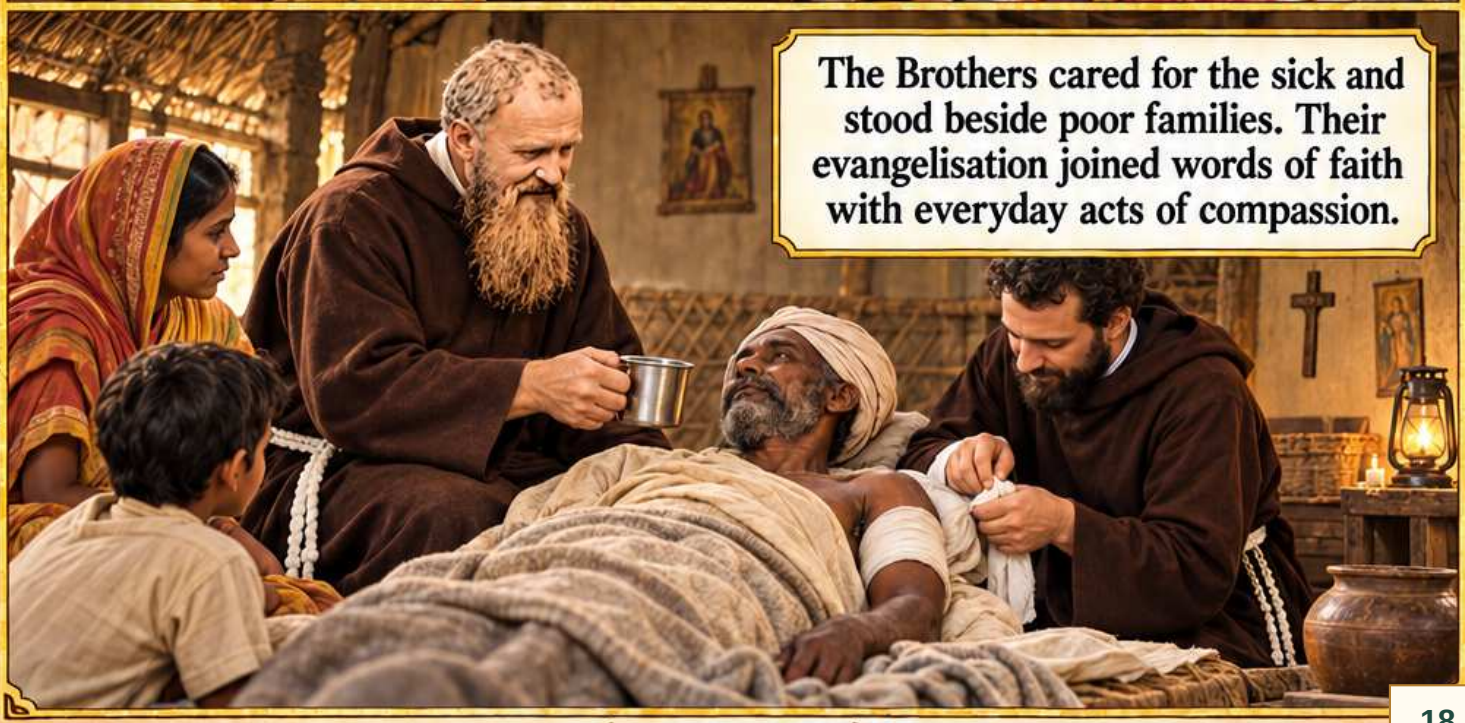
In the Diocese of Nagpur, famine had brought terrible suffering. Paulus and his companions helped hungry families and cared for the sick.



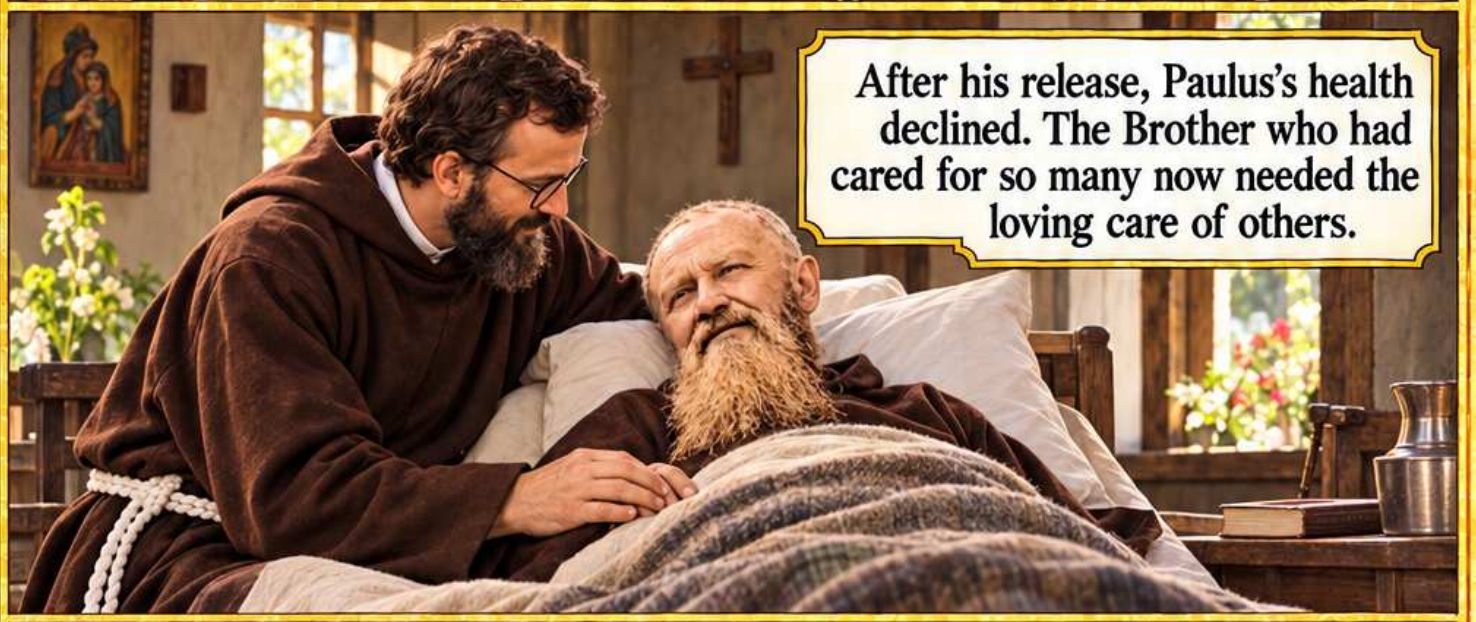
In 1901, the Congregation of the Missionary Brothers of St. Francis of Assisi was founded at Nagpur. Bro. Nicholas Hohn helped Paulus build this new Brotherhood.

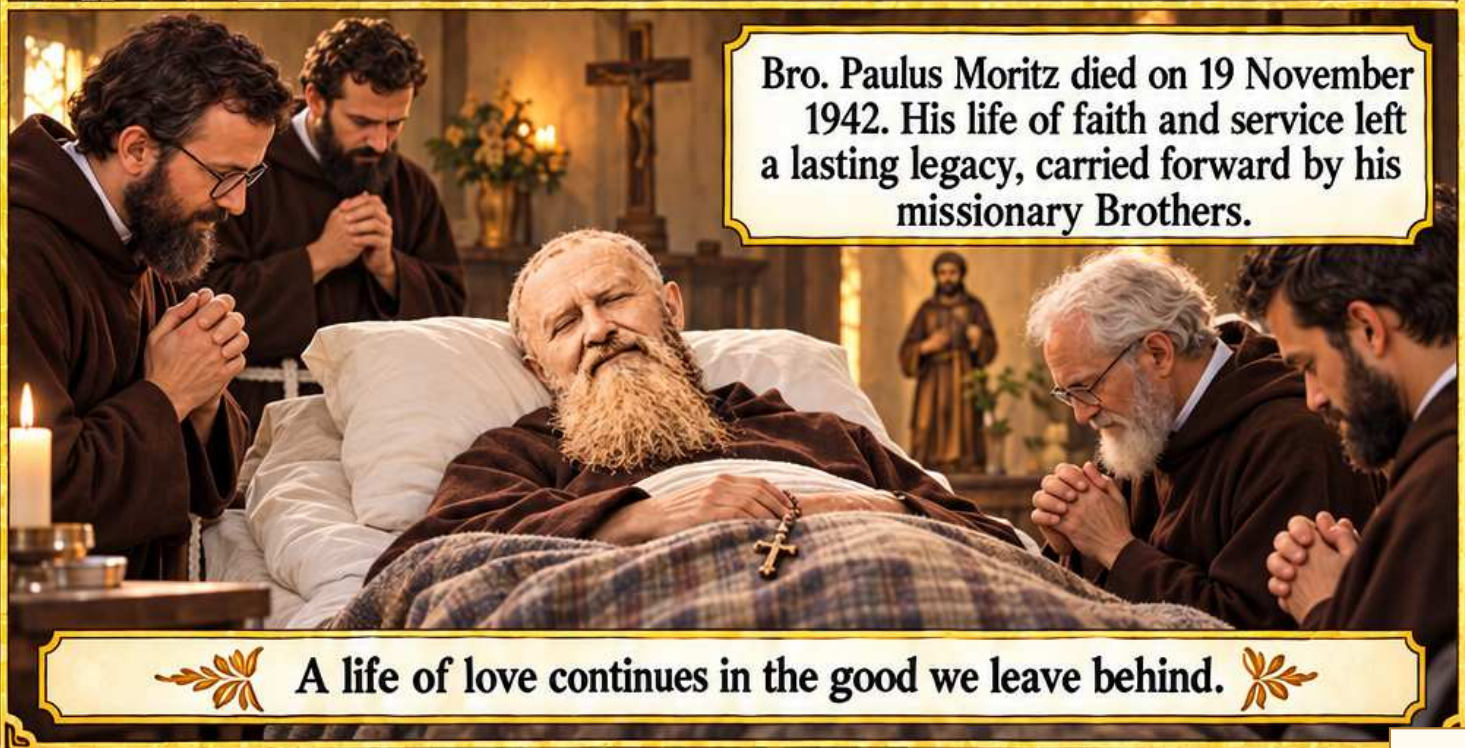

The mission grew. Paulus and the Brothers helped establish churches and schools, sharing the Gospel through teaching, prayer and loving service.


They welcomed orphans and gave children a home, education and practical skills. Every child deserved care, dignity and a hopeful future.
A B C


The Brothers cared for the sick and stood beside poor families. Their evangelisation joined words of faith with everyday acts of compassion.

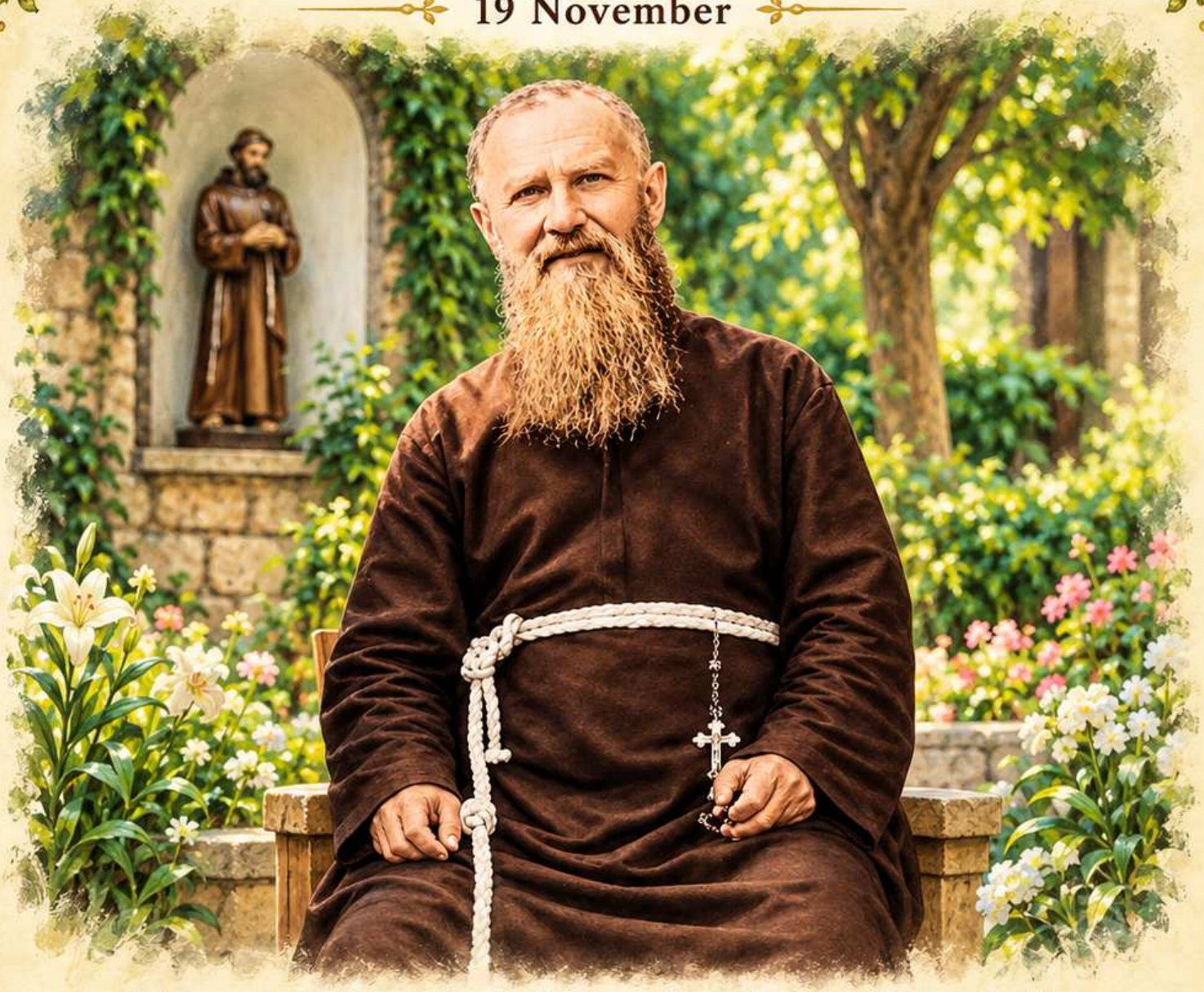

War brought painful trials. During both World Wars, German Brothers in India faced internment. Paulus endured confinement and separation from his beloved mission.


After his release, Paulus's health declined. The Brother who had cared for so many now needed the loving care of others.


Bro. Paulus Moritz died on 19 November 1942. His life of faith and service left a lasting legacy, carried forward by his missionary Brothers.
A life of love continues in the good we leave behind.

A Loving Tribute to
Bro. Paulus Moritz

19 November



Remembering a missionary Brother whose faith became loving service.

He shared the Gospel, fed the hungry, cared for the sick and welcomed children who needed a home.

Through schools, churches and works of mercy, he helped build a Brotherhood devoted to mission.

On 19 November, we remember his life with gratitude. May his example inspire us to love and serve.

May his soul rest in peace.

Pioneer Kids

His Legacy Continues in Ghana



In 2013, the Missionary Brothers of St. Francis of Assisi arrived in Ghana, carrying the missionary spirit of Bro. Paulus Moritz.



With the same spirit of faith and service, the Brothers continue his mission through education, evangelisation and care for people in need.



Working alongside the people of Ghana, they seek to share God's love through brotherhood, prayer and everyday acts of kindness.

The Founder's legacy lives on wherever his Brothers love and serve.

General Knowledge

THE SEVEN NEW WONDERS OF THE WORLD

Chosen by people from around the world in 2007

These seven amazing places were chosen by millions of people from all over the world. They show the beauty, creativity and heritage of

1 Great Wall of China

China



A vast wall built to protect ancient China. It stretches for thousands of kilometres across mountains and valleys.

Fun Fact: It is over 21,000 km long!

2 Petra

Jordan



An ancient city carved into rose-coloured rock. It was an important centre for trade thousands of years ago.

Fun Fact: It is also called the "Rose City" because of its red rock.

3 Christ the Redeemer

Brazil



A huge statue of Jesus Christ standing on Mount Corcovado in Rio de Janeiro.

Fun Fact: The statue is 38 metres tall (including the base).

4 Machu Picchu

Peru



An ancient Inca city high in the Andes Mountains. It shows the amazing skills of the Inca people.

Fun Fact: It was built around 1450, but abandoned later.

5 Chichén Itzá

Mexico



A famous Mayan pyramid and city. It was an important centre for learning, science and religion.

Fun Fact: During the equinox, a special shadow looks like a snake moving down the pyramid!

6 Colosseum

Italy



A huge amphitheatre built by the Romans for games, events and gatherings.

Fun Fact: It could hold about 50,000 spectators!

7 Taj Mahal

India



A beautiful white marble mausoleum built by Emperor Shah Jahan in memory of his beloved wife Mumtaz Mahal.

Fun Fact: It is one of the most famous symbols of love in the world.

These new wonders remind us of the creativity, culture and beauty of different peoples and countries. They are a gift for the whole world.

Different countries • Different cultures • One amazing world!

THE SEVEN WONDERS OF THE ANCIENT WORLD

A List from the Ancient World (around 2nd century BCE)

These seven amazing structures were admired by people in the ancient world. They show the skill, imagination and greatness of ancient civilizations.

1 Great Pyramid of Giza

Egypt



A massive tomb built for Pharaoh Khufu around 2560 BCE.

Fun Fact: It is the only one of the Seven Wonders of the Ancient World that still survives today!

2 Hanging Gardens of Babylon

Iraq (traditinnal location)



A magnificent series of gardens built by King Nebuchadnezzar II for his wife.

Fun Fact: They may have had water-lifting machines to water the plants.

3 Statue of Zeus at Olympia

Greece

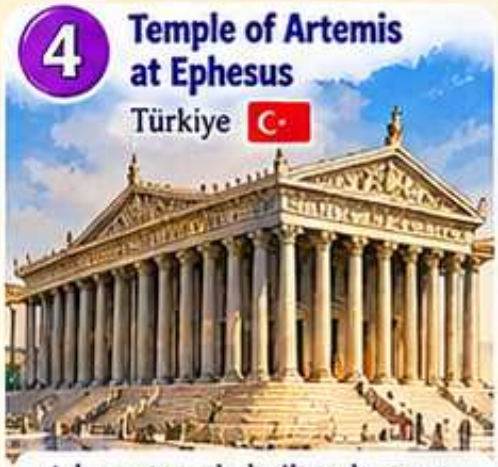


A massive statue of the Greek god Zeus, made of gold and ivory, built by the famous sculptor Phidias.

Fun Fact: It was about 12 metres tall and stood inside a great temple.

4 Temple of Artemis at Ephesus

Türkiye



A huge temple built to honour the goddess Artemis.

Fun Fact: It was famous for its beautiful columns and carvings.

5 Mausoleum at Halicarnassus

Türkiye



A grand tomb built for King Mausolus.

Fun Fact: The word "mausoleum" comes from this wonder.

6 Colossus of Rhodes

Greece



A huge bronze statue of the sun god Helios, built at the entrance of the harbour of Rhodes.

Fun Fact: It was about 33 metres tall (as tall as a modern 10-storey building)!

7 Lighthouse of Alexandria

Egypt

A tall lighthouse built on the island of Pharos to guide ships safely into the harbour.

Fun Fact: It was one of the tallest man-made structures of the ancient world, about 100–120 metres high.

Although most of these wonders no longer exist, they continue to inspire us with the genius and vision of the people who built them.

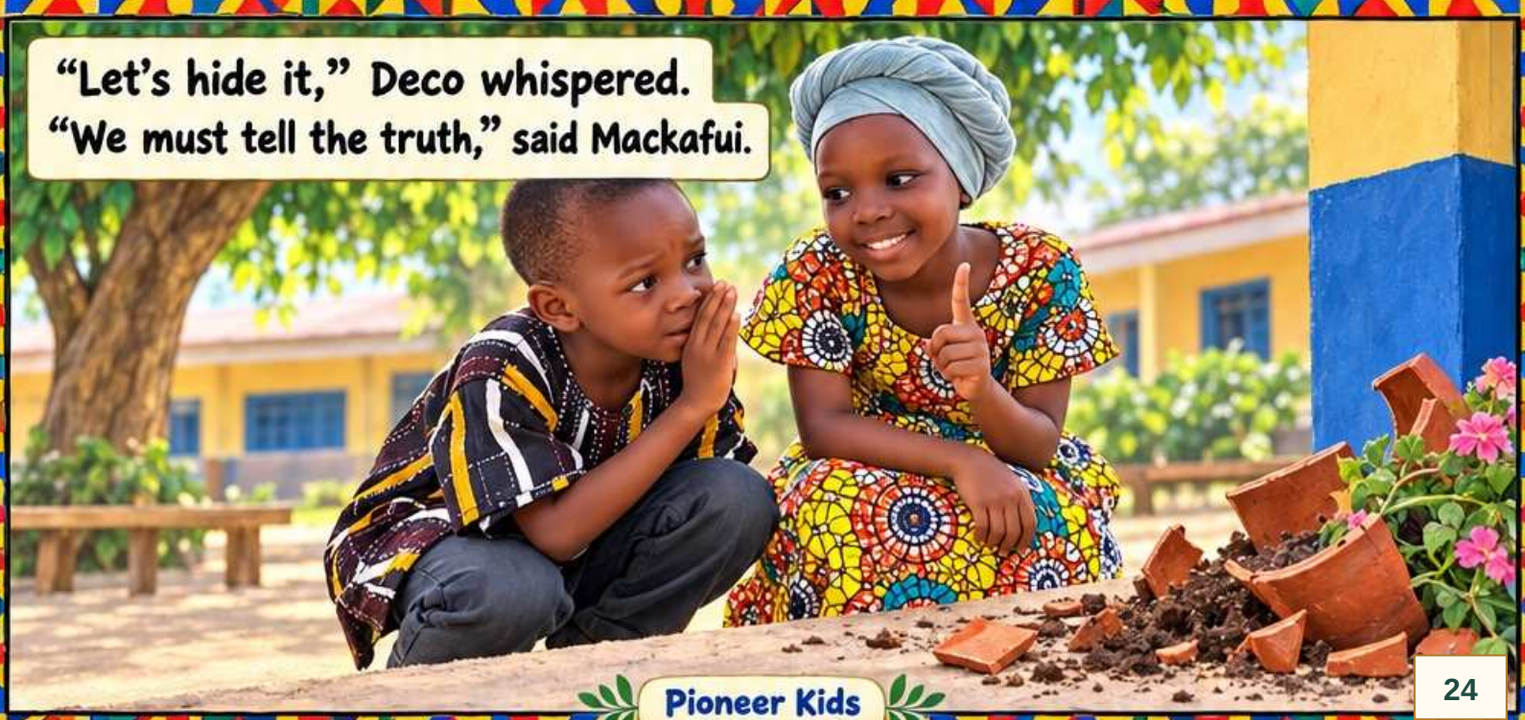


Amazing ideas • Incredible skills • A lasting inspiration for the world!

Mackafui and Deco
The Courage to Tell the Truth







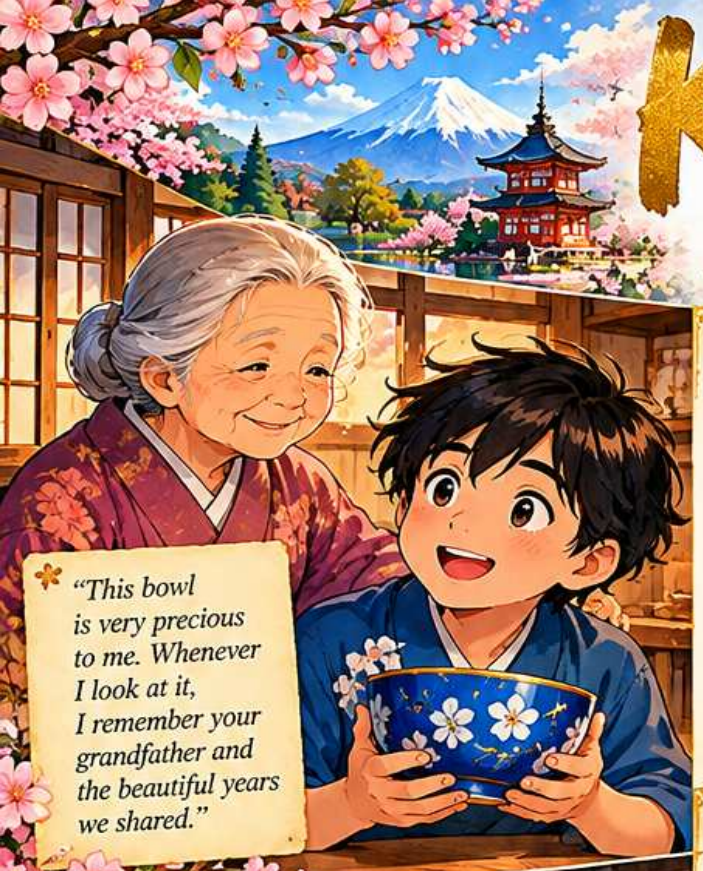

“We broke your pot. We are sorry,” they admitted.
“Thank you for telling the truth. Let’s put things right together,” she said.
They replanted the flowers. Deco smiled. “The truth helped us make things right.”
Always tell the truth—even when it is difficult.
Pioneer Kids

KINTSUGI

THE GOLDEN CRACKS

A Story of Hope, Healing, and New Beginnings

Sometimes, the most beautiful things are those that have been broken and lovingly restored.



1 The Beautiful Blue Bowl

Long ago, in a peaceful village in Japan, there lived a twelve-year-old boy named Haru. Haru lived with his grandmother in a little wooden house surrounded by cherry blossom trees.

His grandmother was a gentle woman who loved flowers, birds, and beautiful pottery. Among her possessions was a lovely blue ceramic bowl decorated with delicate white flowers. The bowl had belonged to Haru's grandfather, who had died many years earlier.

Every evening, Grandmother carefully placed the bowl on a small wooden table. "This bowl is very precious to me," she would tell Haru. "Whenever I look at it, I remember your grandfather and the beautiful years we shared."

Haru knew how much his grandmother loved that bowl.

But one afternoon, something terrible happened.



2 The Day Everything Broke

Haru was playing inside the house when his little wooden ball rolled across the floor. He ran after it. Suddenly, his elbow struck the table.

CRASH!

The beautiful blue bowl fell to the ground and shattered into several pieces.

Haru stood frozen. His heart began to beat faster.

"Oh, no!" he whispered.

He knelt beside the broken pieces. He tried to fit them together, but the bowl would not stay whole. Tears filled his eyes.

"Grandmother will be terribly sad," he thought.

For a moment, Haru wanted to hide the broken pieces. Perhaps he could pretend nothing had happened. But then he remembered something his grandmother often told him:

"A mistake becomes worse when we cover it with a lie."

Gathering his courage, Haru went to find her.



3 A Grandmother's Wisdom

"Grandmother," he said, his voice trembling, "I have done something terrible."

She looked at him kindly. "What happened, my child?"

"I broke Grandfather's beautiful bowl. I am very sorry." Tears rolled down his cheeks.

His grandmother walked into the room and saw the broken pieces. For a moment, she remained silent. Then she gently placed her hand on Haru's shoulder.

"My dear boy, I loved that bowl very much. But I love you far more."

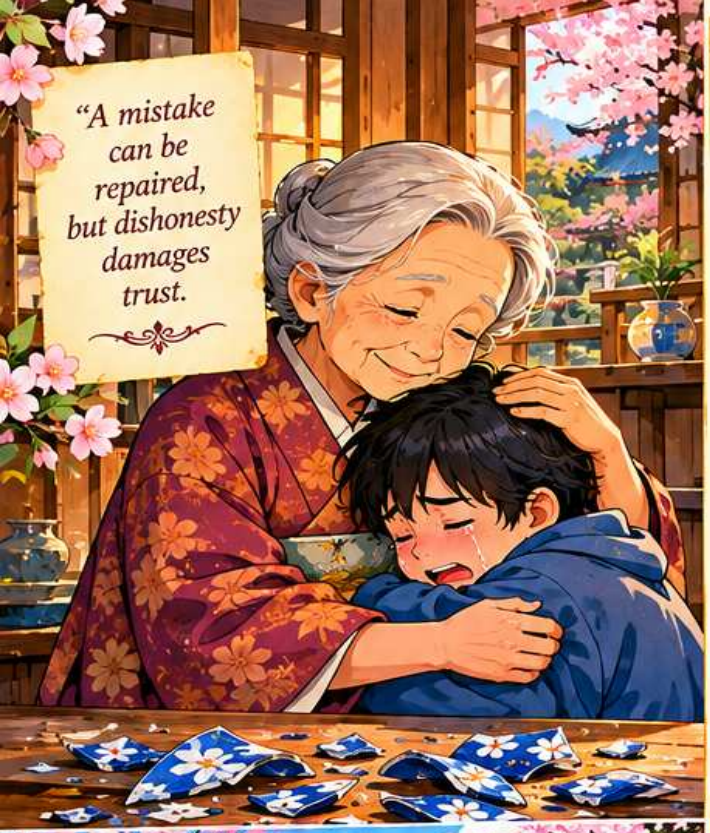
Haru looked up in surprise. "Are you not angry with me?"

"I am sad that the bowl is broken," she replied. "But I am happy that you told me the truth."

Then she smiled. "Perhaps the bowl has not reached the end of its story."

Haru looked puzzled. "What do you mean, Grandmother?"

"Tomorrow, we shall visit an old friend of mine. He knows how to give broken things a new life."



4 A Grandmother's Wisdom

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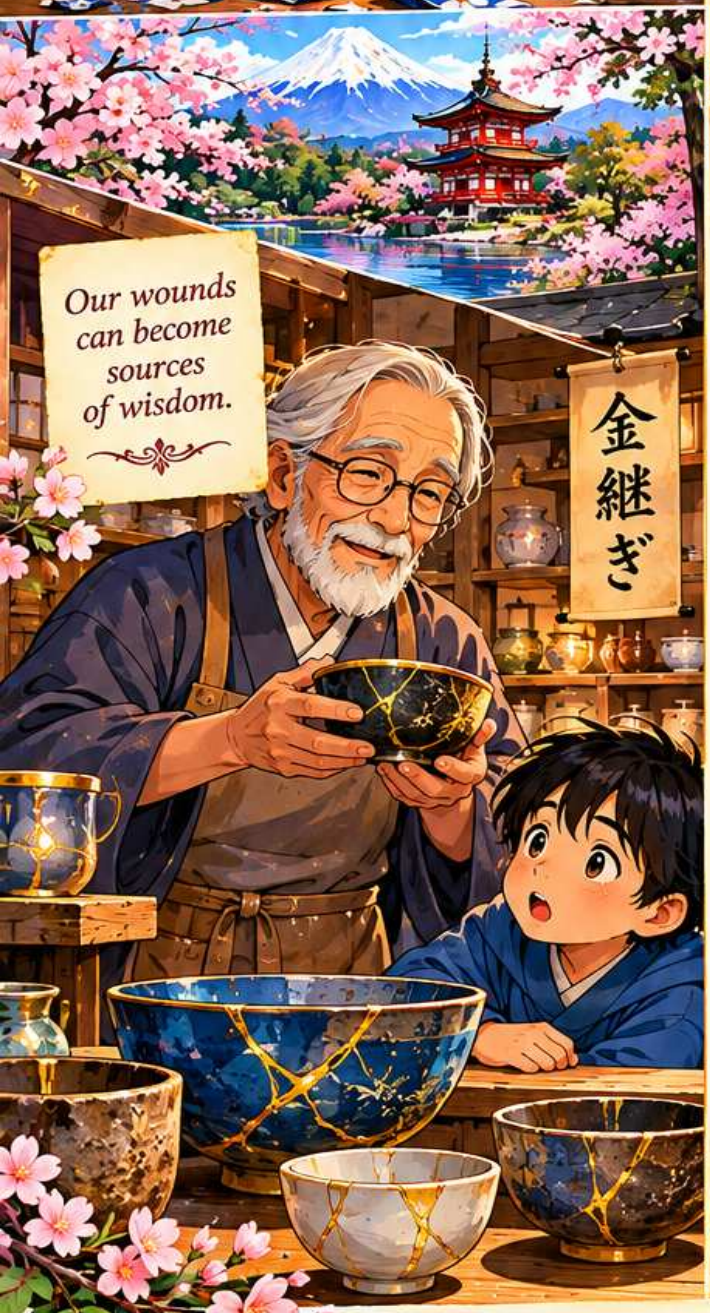
"I am sad that the bowl is broken," she replied. "But I am happy that you told me the truth."

Then she smiled. "Perhaps the bowl has not reached the end of its story."

Haru looked puzzled. "What do you mean, Grandmother?"

"Tomorrow, we shall visit an old friend of mine. He knows how to give broken things a new life."

"We cannot always prevent things from breaking. But we can choose how lovingly we respond."



5 The Master of Golden Cracks

The following morning, Grandmother and Haru visited an elderly craftsman named Master Kenji. His little workshop was filled with beautiful pottery. Some bowls were red, others green, and a few were decorated with golden lines.

Haru noticed something unusual. "Master Kenji," he asked, "why do some of your bowls have gold running through them?"

The old craftsman smiled. "Those are not ordinary decorations, my boy. They are the places where the bowls were once broken."

Haru opened his eyes wide. "Broken? But they look so beautiful!"

Master Kenji picked up a bowl covered with delicate golden lines. "This is called Kintsugi," he explained. "In Japan, we have a traditional art of repairing broken pottery with special lacquer and powdered gold."

He turned the bowl slowly in his hands. "Instead of hiding the cracks, we make them visible. We honour the history of the object."

Haru examined the golden lines. "But why don't you make the bowl look exactly as it did before?"

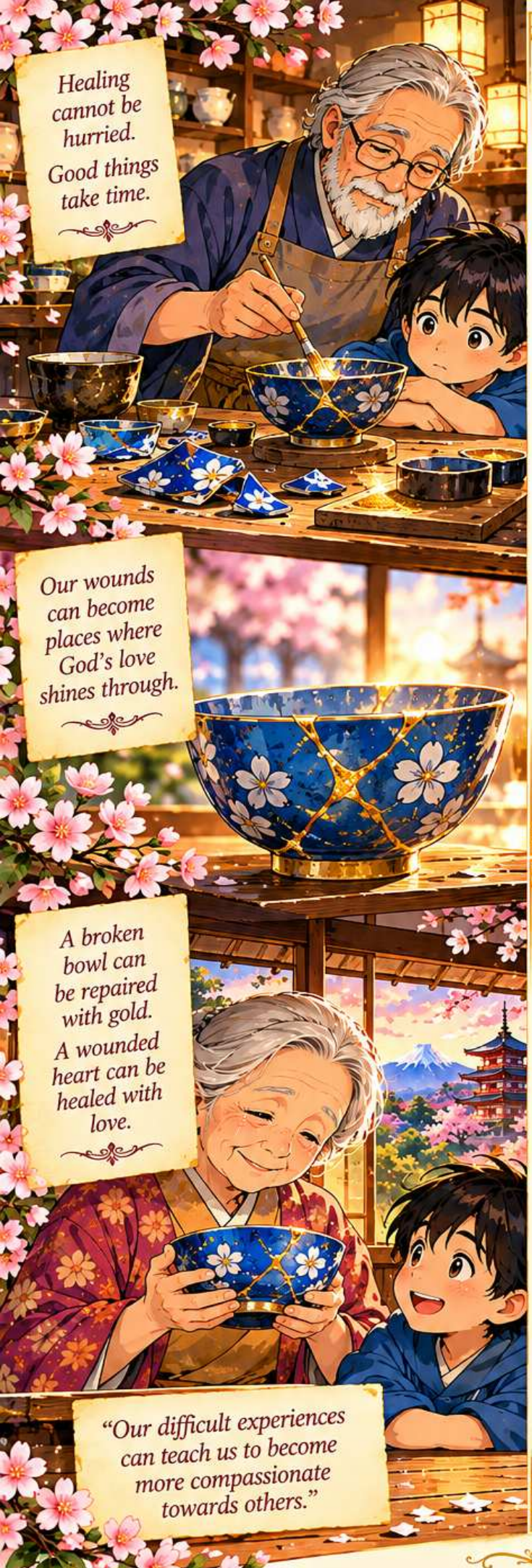
Master Kenji answered: "Because its brokenness is now part of its story. We do not need to erase its past to make it beautiful again."

Master Kenji agreed to repair Grandmother's bowl. But he warned Haru that the work would take time.

"Can you finish it today?" Haru asked eagerly.

The craftsman shook his head. "No, my boy. Beautiful restoration requires patience."

"Never judge the value of a person by the wounds they carry."



6 The Patient Work of Healing

Master Kenji agreed to repair Grandmother's bowl. But he warned Haru that the work would take time.

"Can you finish it today?" Haru asked eagerly.

The craftsman shook his head. "No, my boy. Beautiful restoration requires patience."

Over the following days, Haru visited the workshop. He watched Master Kenji carefully join the broken pieces using traditional lacquer. The repaired areas needed time to harden before the next steps could begin.

Finally, the craftsman decorated the repaired lines with fine gold powder. Day after day, the old bowl slowly became whole again.

Haru began to understand something important. Healing could not be hurried.

One afternoon, Master Kenji said: "Haru, remember this. People are sometimes like broken pottery."

"What do you mean?"

"Sometimes our hearts are wounded by disappointment, failure, rejection, or unkind words." Haru listened carefully.

"Some children feel they are worthless because they make mistakes. Others believe their lives are ruined because something painful has happened."

The craftsman paused. "But a broken bowl is still a bowl. And a wounded person is still precious."

Then he added: "Never judge the value of a person by the wounds they carry."

"Healing takes time, care, and love. What was once broken can become meaningful again."

7 The Bowl More Beautiful Than Before

At last, the great day arrived. Master Kenji placed the restored bowl before Haru and his grandmother.

Haru could hardly believe his eyes. The blue bowl was now decorated with beautiful golden lines. The cracks looked like tiny rivers of sunlight flowing across its surface.

"Grandmother!" Haru exclaimed. "It is beautiful!"

His grandmother held the bowl gently. Tears appeared in her eyes.

"It is different from the bowl your grandfather gave me," she whispered. "But it is still precious. Now it carries another memory—the day my grandson learned the value of truth and forgiveness."

Haru embraced her. "I will never forget this lesson, Grandmother."

She smiled. "Remember, Haru, we cannot always prevent things from breaking. But we can choose how lovingly we respond."

"A broken bowl can be repaired with gold. A wounded heart can be healed with love."



8 The Boy Who Remembered the Golden Cracks

Several months later, something happened at Haru's school.

A boy named Taro accidentally dropped a clay sculpture he had spent many days making. The sculpture broke into pieces.

Some children laughed. "What a disaster!" one boy shouted.

"You are so careless!" said another.

Taro sat alone, trying not to cry.

Haru remembered the broken blue bowl. He walked over and sat beside him. "Don't be sad, Taro," he said. "My grandmother once had a beautiful bowl that I broke."

"What happened to it?" Taro asked.

"We repaired it using a Japanese art called Kintsugi."

Haru explained how the broken pieces had been joined together and decorated with gold.

Then he said: "Perhaps we can repair your sculpture too. It may not look exactly the same, but we can try."

Together, the boys gathered the pieces and asked their art teacher for help.

The teacher smiled. "What a wonderful idea!"

Over the following days, the children worked together to restore the sculpture. They used suitable craft materials and painted its repaired lines gold. It was not traditional Kintsugi, but it was inspired by the same beautiful idea.

When they finished, the sculpture looked different—but special.

Taro smiled again.

And Haru discovered another important truth:

"The most beautiful thing we can repair is sometimes not an object, but someone's broken confidence."

9 The Golden Lesson

Years passed. Haru grew into a kind and thoughtful young man.

Whenever he faced difficulties, he remembered Master Kenji's golden bowls.

When he failed an examination, he did not give up.

When someone hurt his feelings, he tried to forgive.

When he made mistakes, he accepted responsibility and learned from them.

And whenever he met someone who was suffering, he tried to offer encouragement.

He understood that the real meaning of Kintsugi was not simply repairing pottery. For him, it had become a lesson about the human heart.

Our mistakes do not have to define our future.

Our wounds do not take away our dignity.

And our difficult experiences can teach us to become more compassionate towards others.

One evening, Haru returned to his grandmother's house.

The beautiful blue bowl still stood on the wooden table.

Its golden lines shone in the evening sunlight.

Haru smiled.

The bowl had been broken.

But its story had not ended.

And neither does ours.

"A broken bowl can be repaired with gold. A wounded heart can be healed with love."

"Our wounds can become signs of hope, compassion and wisdom."

"A broken bowl can be repaired with gold. A wounded heart can be healed with love."

"You are more valuable than your mistakes. You do not need to be perfect to be loved."

10 A Message for Every Child

Dear young friends,

Have you ever broken something precious? Have you ever failed an examination, disappointed your parents, lost a friendship, or felt that nobody understood you? Have you ever thought, "I am not good enough"?

Remember the beautiful lesson of Kintsugi.

You are more valuable than your mistakes.

You do not need to be perfect to be loved.

When something goes wrong, have the courage to tell the truth.

When you hurt someone, ask forgiveness.

When someone else makes a mistake, offer kindness instead of ridicule.

And when life becomes difficult, remember that hope can grow even through painful experiences.

11 A Christian Reflection



After His Resurrection, Jesus appeared to His disciples. He still carried the wounds of the Cross. Those wounds reminded His followers of His suffering and His extraordinary love. Jesus showed that suffering and death did not have the final word. God's love is greater.

Like the golden lines of Kintsugi, our experiences of suffering can become reminders of healing, courage, and hope.

"He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."
Psalm 147:3

12 Five Golden Lessons

1. **Be truthful.**
   A mistake can be repaired, but dishonesty damages trust.
2. **Learn to forgive.**
   Forgiveness helps wounded relationships heal.
3. **Never give up.**
   Failure is not the end of your journey.
4. **Be kind to wounded hearts.**
   Your gentle words may give someone the courage to begin again.
5. **Remember your worth.**
   You are precious, even when life is difficult.

13 A Little Prayer

Dear Jesus,
When I make mistakes, give me courage to tell the truth.
When my heart is wounded, fill me with hope.
When others suffer, teach me to be gentle and kind.
May Your love transform our sadness into compassion,
our failures into wisdom,
and our wounds into opportunities for healing.
Amen.

BROKEN DOES NOT MEAN WORTHLESS.
Your story is not over!

Bible Story

The Lost Sheep

The Shepherd's Endless Love

Jesus told this story to show how much God loves each one of us.

No one is too small, no one is forgotten. God always looks for us.

Based on Luke 15:3–7

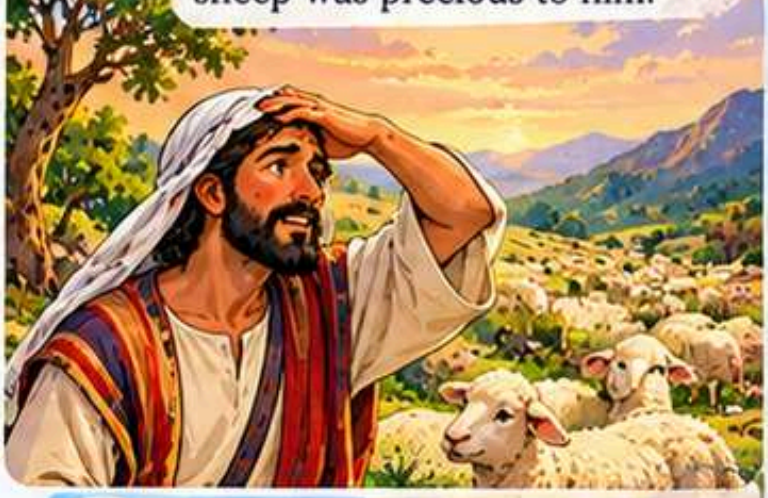
1 A Caring Shepherd

A shepherd had one hundred sheep. He loved them and took good care of them. Every day he led them to green pastures and safe places.



2 One Sheep is Missing

One day, as the shepherd counted his sheep, he realised that one sheep was missing. He was very sad. That one sheep was precious to him.



3 He Searches Everywhere

The shepherd left the ninety-nine sheep in a safe place and went to look for the lost sheep. He searched on the hills, among the rocks and in the bushes. He did not give up.



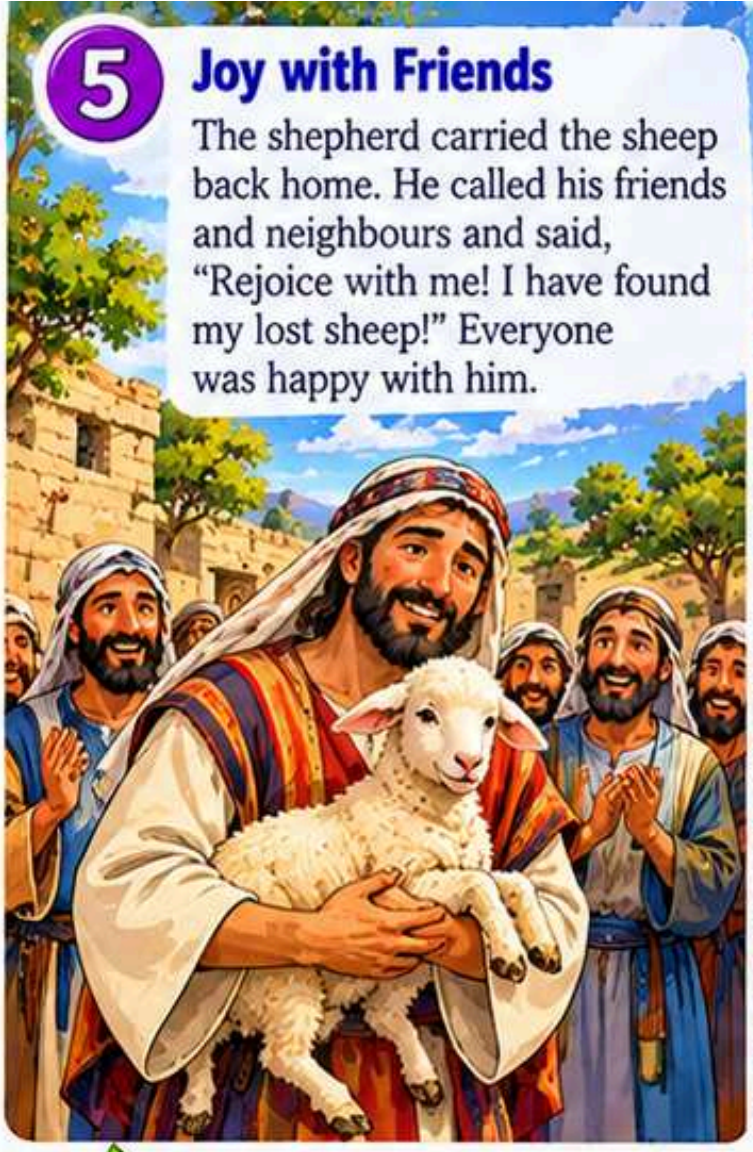
4 The Lost Sheep is Found

At last, the shepherd heard a faint baa. The lost sheep was stuck among some rocks. The shepherd gently lifted it, carried it in his arms and was overjoyed!



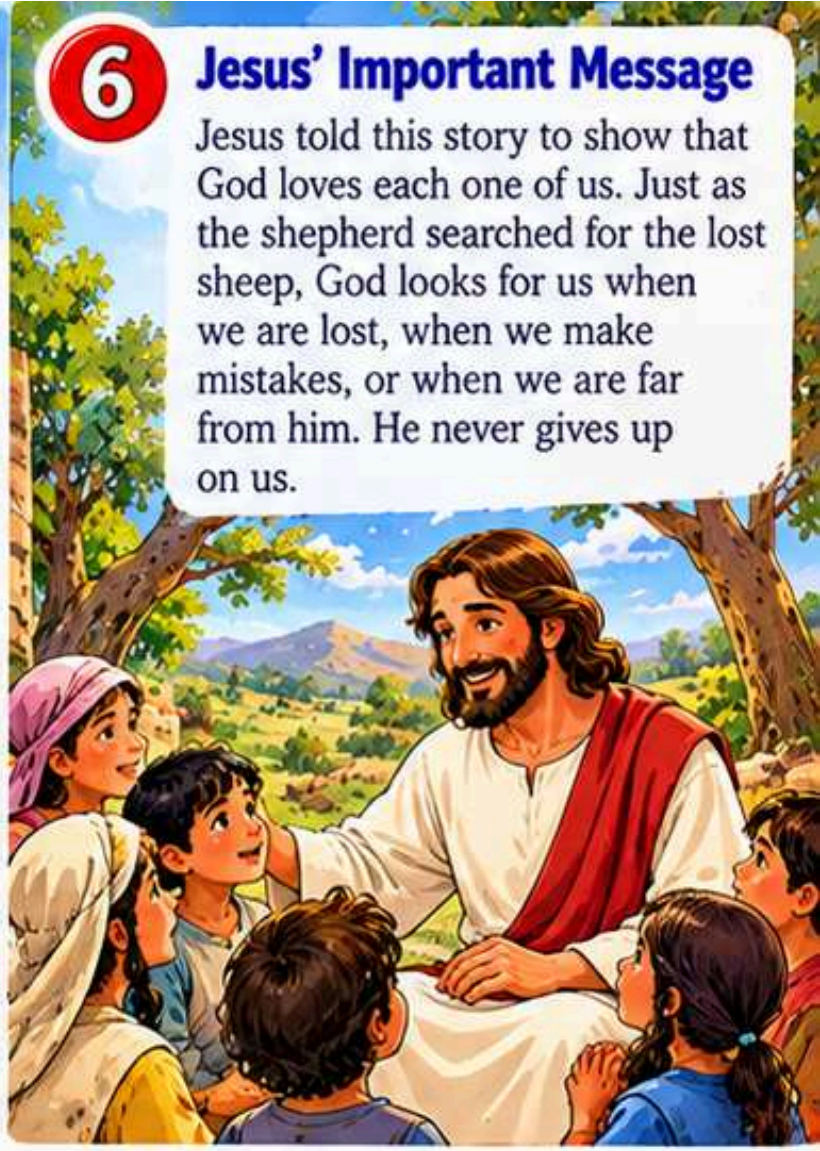
5 Joy with Friends

The shepherd carried the sheep back home. He called his friends and neighbours and said, "Rejoice with me! I have found my lost sheep!" Everyone was happy with him.



6 Jesus' Important Message

Jesus told this story to show that God loves each one of us. Just as the shepherd searched for the lost sheep, God looks for us when we are lost, when we make mistakes, or when we are far from him. He never gives up on us.



What We Learn

- God loves each one of us.
- He looks for us when we are lost or in trouble.
- We are never too small or unimportant.
- We should also care for and look out for others.
- We can bring joy when we help someone who is lonely or left out.



A Verse to Remember

"There will be more joy in heaven over one sinner who repents than over ninety-nine righteous persons who do not need to repent."
Luke 15:7

Let's Think

1. Why did the shepherd leave the ninety-nine sheep?
2. What do you think the shepherd felt when he found the lost sheep?
3. How does this story show us God's love?
4. How can you look out for someone who feels lonely or left out?

THE DAY KOJO ASKED A QUESTION.

A fictional vocation story.



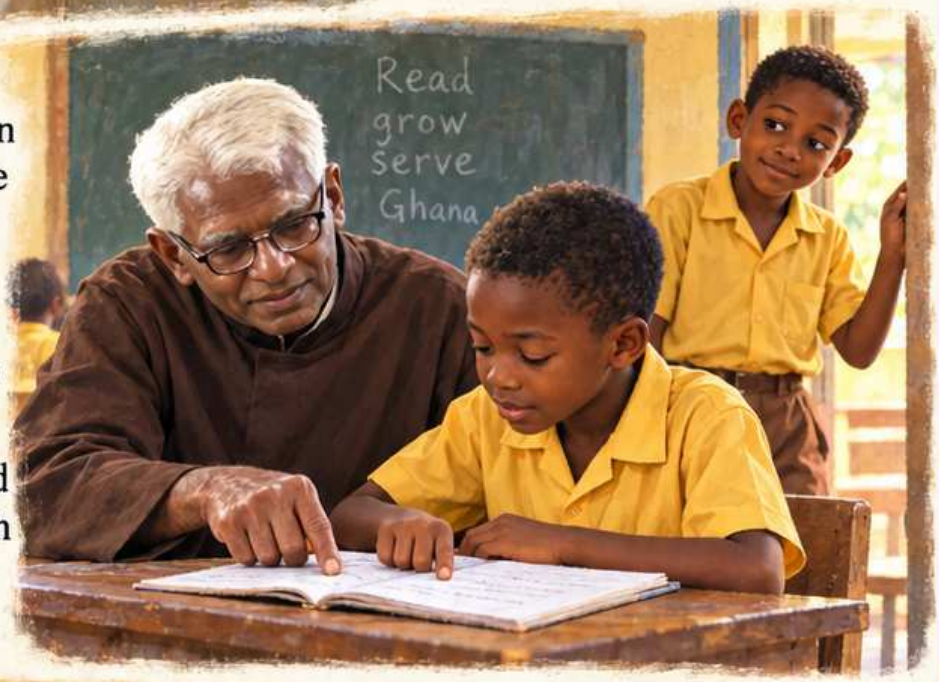
Kojo liked watching the road outside his school. Whenever a car passed, he imagined himself behind the wheel.

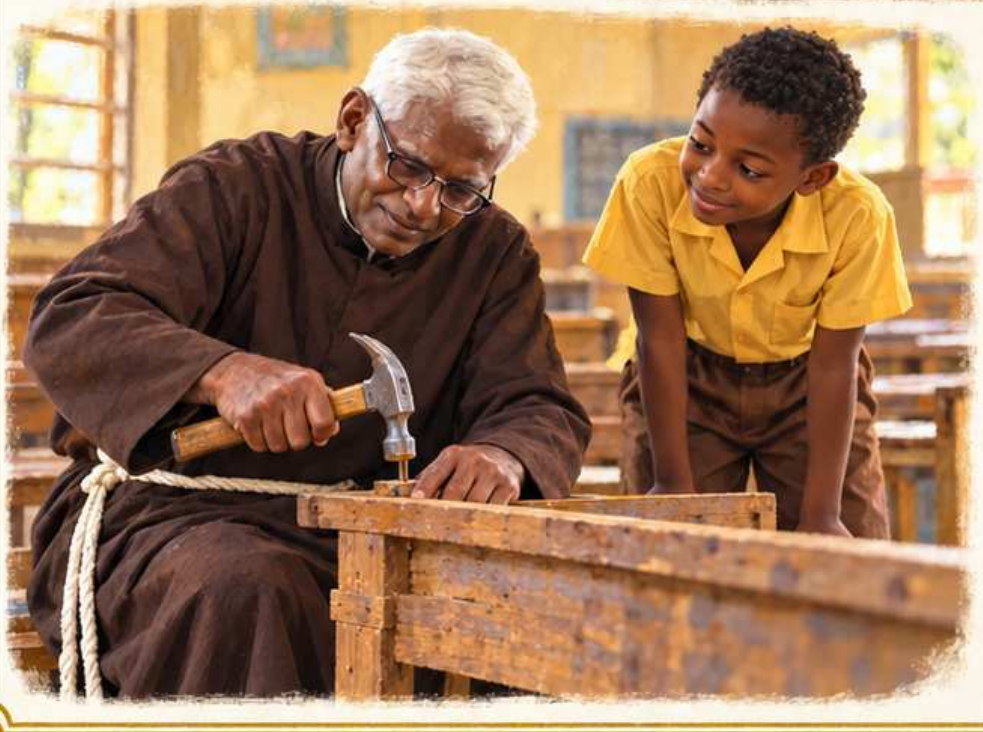
"One day, I will drive across Ghana!" he told his friend Ama.

But one afternoon, something in the classroom caught his attention.

A little boy named Kofi was struggling to read. Some children had finished their work and gone outside. Kofi stayed at his desk, staring at the same sentence.

Bro. Boniface pulled up a chair beside him. "Let us try together," he said. Kojo lingered near the doorway. The Brother listened patiently as Kofi sounded out each word. When the boy finally read the sentence, they both smiled.





The next day, Kojo found Bro. Boniface repairing a broken desk.

"Brother, are you a teacher or a carpenter?"

"A teacher who is still learning how to mend desks," the Brother replied, laughing.

"Then why does everyone call you Brother?"



Bro. Boniface set down his tools. "I am a religious Brother. I have chosen to follow Jesus through prayer, community life and service. I belong to a family of Brothers, and together we try to share God's love."

"Do you have to travel far away?"

"Some Brothers do. Others serve close to home. Wherever we are, there are people to love and work to do."

Kojo thought about this as he walked home.

That evening, his younger sister asked him to help with her homework. Usually, he would have hurried outside to play. This time, he sat beside her.

"Let us try together," he said.





Weeks passed. Kojo began helping younger pupils read. Sometimes he enjoyed it. Sometimes he grew impatient.

One day, Kofi forgot a word they had practised many times. "You knew this yesterday!" Kojo exclaimed. Kofi lowered his head.

Kojo remembered how patiently Bro. Boniface had helped him. "I am sorry," he said. "We can try again."



Years later, Kojo still remembered those afternoons. He enjoyed learning, working with his hands and helping children. He also found himself wondering about life as a Brother. He spoke with his family, prayed, and asked Bro. Boniface many questions.

"How will I know whether God is calling me?"

"You can take time to listen," the Brother said. "Come and learn about our life. Ask questions. Discover its joys and its difficulties. A vocation grows through an honest, free response."

As a young adult, Kojo visited a Brothers' community. He joined their prayers, shared their meals and helped with their work. Gradually, he decided to begin formation. He still loved travelling. Now he was discovering another journey: learning to follow Jesus as a missionary Brother.

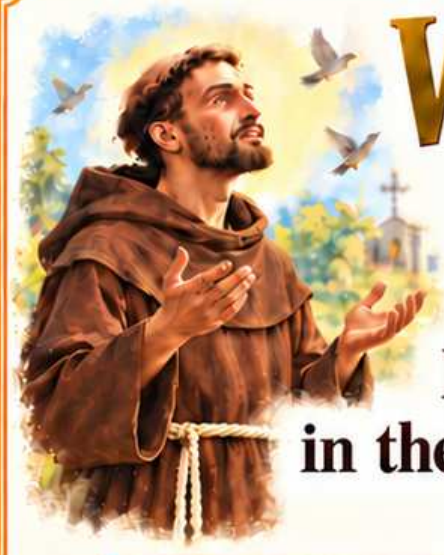




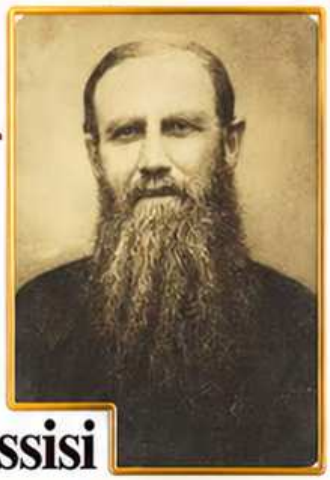
And whenever a child struggled with a lesson, he pulled up a chair.

"Let us try together," he said.

You can begin listening to God's call today through prayer, kindness and the faithful use of your gifts.

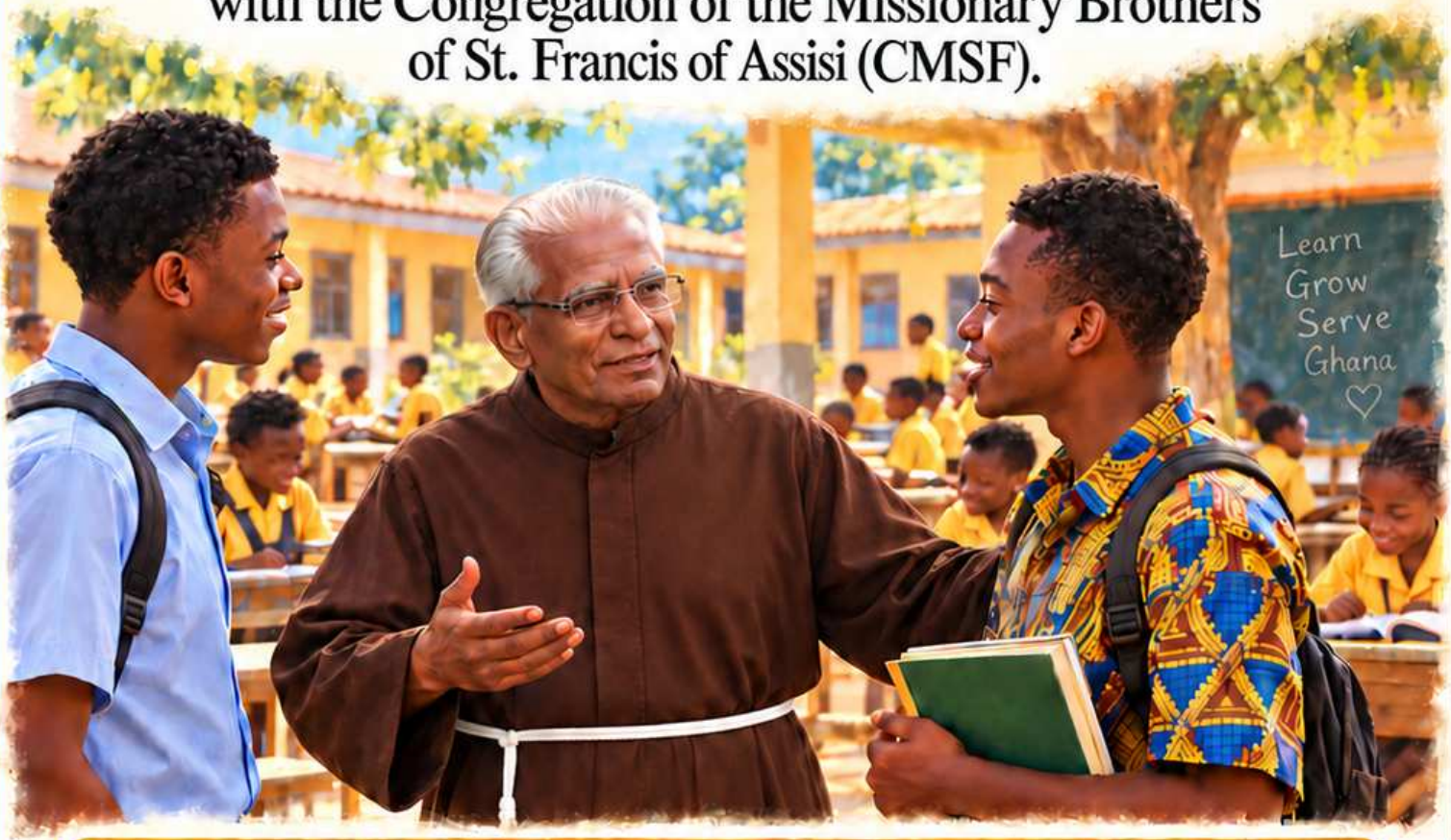


WALK IN THEIR FOOTSTEPS



Do you wish to follow Jesus in the footsteps of St. Francis of Assisi and Bro. Paulus Moritz?

Discover a life of prayer, brotherhood and missionary service with the Congregation of the Missionary Brothers of St. Francis of Assisi (CMSF).

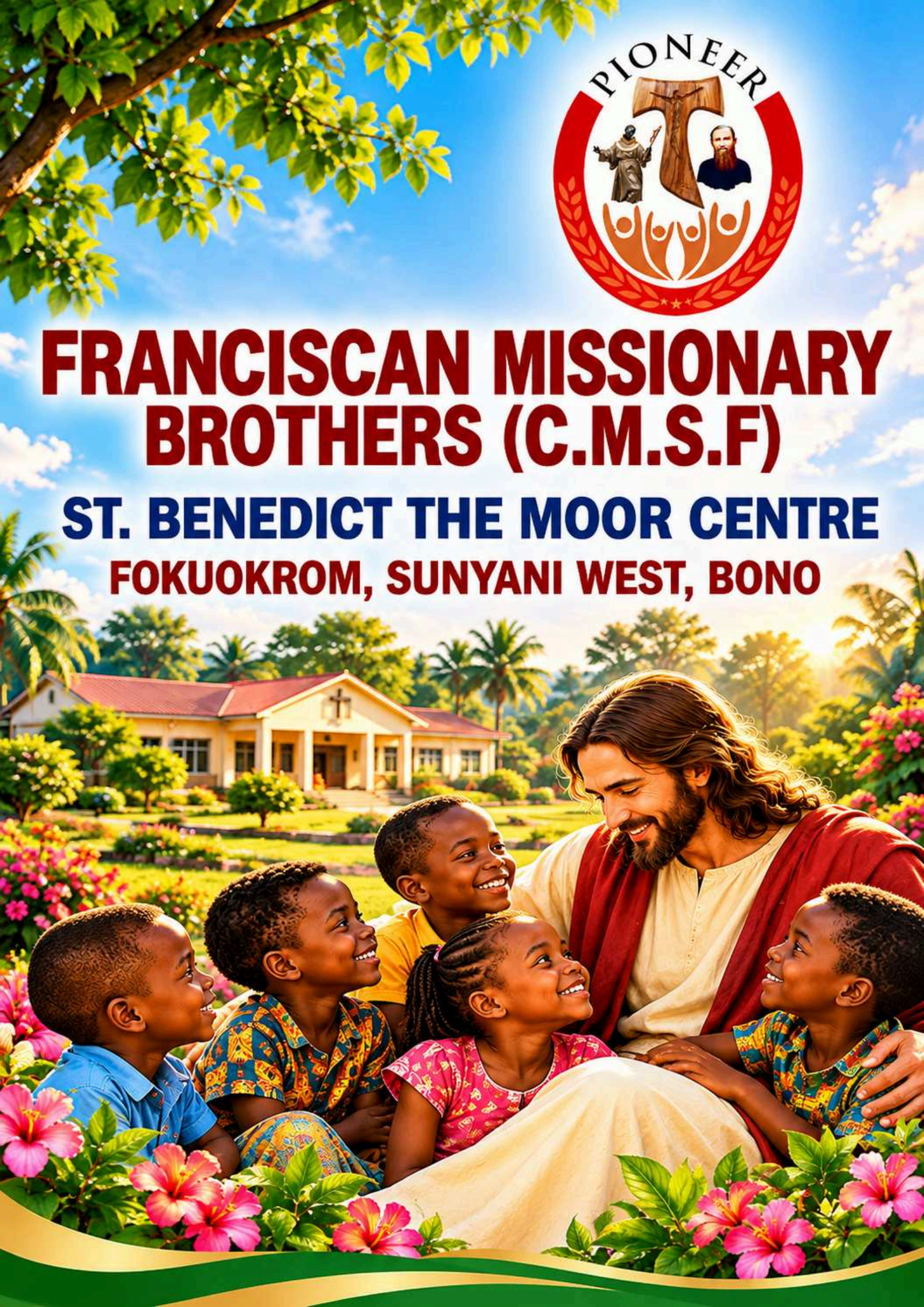


For vocation enquiries, contact:

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+233 54 608 0364

Take the first step.
Ask, pray and discern.


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